Before you begin

Fitness: my diary and my life story

Keeping a diary

Buy a notebook or journal that you keep just for this programme. Start writing in it today, every day until your cohort begins, and keep going through the 28 days. You don't need to change anything yet: just notice, and write it down. Nobody else needs to read it.

Each time you move, and after long stretches of sitting, write down:

- The time, and what you did (or how long you sat).
- How long it lasted.
- Whether you were alone, or who you were with.
- Your energy and mood before, and after.
- What helped you move, or what got in the way.

At the end of each day, write a few lines:

- How much did I move today? How long did I sit for?
- What got in the way of moving? What made it easier?
- How did I feel in my body today, and about my body?
- What emotions came up around exercise?
- One thing I noticed about myself today.

My life story

Take your time with these. Write in your journal over a few days, as much or as little as feels right. There are no right answers: just be honest with yourself.

1. What are your earliest memories of moving your body: sport, play, dance, walking? How did it feel?

2. When did being active become harder, or stop? What was happening in your life at that time?

3. How has your relationship with exercise and your body changed over the years?

4. What does a typical week of movement look like for you now?

5. What does not moving give you? Rest, comfort, avoiding something, time for other things?

6. Which emotions get in the way of moving: tiredness, low mood, self-consciousness, stress, overwhelm?

7. What did you learn about exercise and bodies growing up, from family, school or friends?

8. What have you tried before to get fitter, and what did you learn from it? What worked, even for a while?

9. What does staying inactive cost you: energy, health, sleep, mood, confidence?

10. What has brought you to this group, now?

11. Who are you becoming? Describe a day in your life as someone who moves every day.